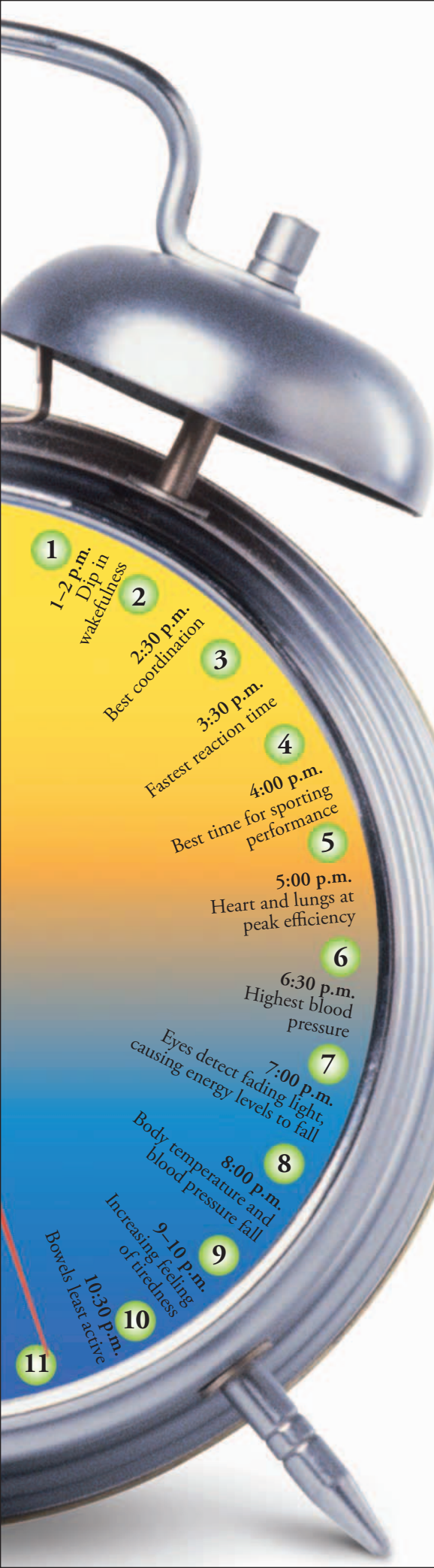




LIGHT THERAPY

The cycle of day and night, detected by our eyes, governs not just the body clock but other brain functions too. In countries with long, dark winters, lack of daylight can cause a kind of depression called seasonal affective disorder (SAD). People with this problem sometimes use bright light to try and relieve symptoms.

WOW!

The average person has a body clock of 24 hours and 11 minutes.

JET LAG

If you fly to a distant country in a different time zone, your body clock will be out of sync with the local time and you'll experience jet lag. This condition makes it hard to sleep at night and hard to stay awake during the day. After a few days in the new time zone, your body clock resets automatically and jet lag disappears.



ARE YOU AN OWL OR A LARK?

1. When your alarm clock wakes you up, do you:

- a. Get right out of bed?
- b. Switch it off and get up slowly?
- c. Put the alarm clock on snooze?
- d. Switch it off and go back to sleep?

2. What time do you go to bed on Friday evenings?

- a. 8:00–9:00 p.m.
- b. 9:00–10:00 p.m.
- c. 10:00–11:00 p.m.
- d. After 11:00 p.m.

3. What time do you get up on Saturday mornings?

- a. Before 9:00 a.m.
- b. 9:00–10:00 a.m.
- c. 10:00–11:00 a.m.
- d. After 11:00 a.m.

4. How hungry are you when you eat breakfast?

- a. Very hungry
- b. Only slightly hungry
- c. Not really hungry but you make an effort to eat
- d. Disgusted by the thought of food

5. At what time of day do you feel most energetic?

- a. Morning
- b. Afternoon
- c. Evening
- d. Late at night

6. How long does it take you to fall asleep?

- a. Under 10 minutes
- b. 10–20 minutes
- c. 20–30 minutes
- d. More than 30 minutes

Add up your points for each question to work out your score: a = 4 points, b = 3 points, c = 2 points, d = 1 point. 6–11 points: You're an owl and you love staying up late. But you might be sleep-deprived, which could make you bad-tempered during the day and hurt your studies. Try going to bed a little earlier on weekdays if you think you need more sleep. 12–18 points: You're neither an owl nor a lark, and you probably have sensible sleeping habits. 19–24 points: You're a lark and you love the mornings. Consider yourself lucky—most people hate getting up early.

RESULTS

